Shell Drill

TEAM DEFENSE / POSITIONING / COMMUNICATION

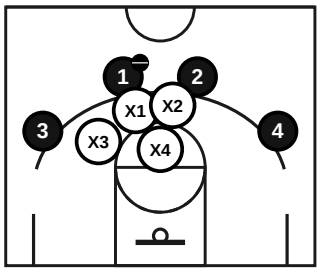
Four defenders shift together through ball pressure, deny, help, and split-line responsibilities.

8 PLAYERS | 1 BALL | HALF COURT

STEP 1

SET THE SHELL

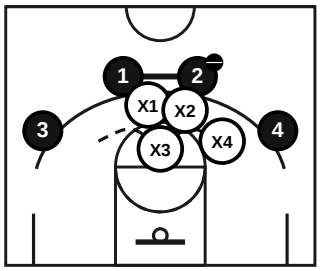
Pressure the ball. One pass away, deny. On the weak side, drop to help and see both ball and player.



STEP 2

FLY WITH THE FIRST PASS

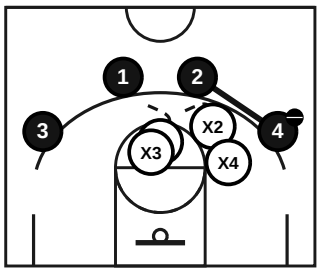
On the pass, the new on-ball defender closes out. One pass away, deny. Weak-side defenders drop to help.



STEP 3

SHIFT TO THE WING

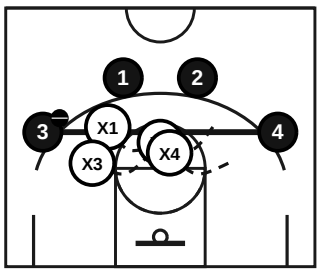
As the ball moves to the wing, close out to the ball. One pass away, deny. Weak-side defenders drop to help and find the split line.



STEP 4

HELP ACROSS THE SHELL

As the ball reverses, close out to the ball. One pass away, deny. Weak-side defenders drop to help while seeing ball and player.



STEP 5

ROTATE AND PROGRESS

Switch offense and defense. Repeat, then progress to cuts, denial, penetration, screens, and live four-on-four.

VARIATIONS

- Allow every pass until rotations are understood.
- Add V-cuts and perimeter replacements.
- Require denial once positioning is sound.
- Add penetration and help-and-recover.
- Add exchanges, then screens.
- Finish live four-on-four; high defenders may sag by scheme.